Unit 3 — Fairness at School

Track E · Klasse 8 · Niveau E

Learning objectives I

- *I can argue a school-fairness point in 5 sentences.*
- *I can use the second conditional (*if I were … I would …*).*
- *I can use connectives of contrast (*although, however, on the other hand*).*

Lead-in I

Jonas's class is voting on a new rule: *no phones at lunch*. Half the class is for it. The other half thinks it is mostly aimed at one group of students who happen to be loud anyway. Hawa says, "If I were the headteacher, I would ask why we are voting on phones and not on actual fairness."

Vocabulary I

- rule
- rights
- equal
- equality
- privilege
- discrimination
- exception
- vote
- debate
- agree
- disagree
- valid

Vocabulary I

- biased
- neutral
- inclusive

Reading I

Vocabulary — fairness
rule, rights, equal, equality, privilege, discrimination, exception, vote, debate, agree, disagree, valid, biased, neutral, inclusive.

Grammar — second conditional
Structure: *If* + past simple, *would* + base verb.

- *If I were the headteacher, I would change the rule.*
- *If we voted, it would be close.*

Reading II

- *I wouldn't ban phones if I had to enforce the rule myself.*

Were (not *was*) is preferred for *I/he/she/it* in formal writing: *If I* ***were*** *you …*

Connectives of contrast
although, however, on the other hand, even though, still, but, yet.

- *Although the rule is meant to help, it doesn't.*
- *However, I see the point of the original idea.*
- *On the other hand, fairness has limits.*

Practise I

Niveau E — controlled

1. Fill in second conditional: If I _____ (be) the headteacher, I _____ (change) the rule.
2. Connective fill-in: ___ I agree with the rule, I think it is unfair to one group. (although)

Niveau E — productive

3. Build 3 second-conditional sentences and 2 contrast sentences about a school rule you would change.

Your turn I

Mini-debate. Two teams of 4. The motion: *This class would replace the no-phones rule with a no-loud-phones rule.* Each speaker uses one second conditional + one contrast connective. Two minutes per side.

Sample
— If we replaced the rule, we would still have quiet lunch tables. However, some people just wouldn't follow it. — On the other hand, the current rule punishes everyone for the loudness of a few.

Reflect I

- I can argue a school-fairness point in 5 sentences.
- I can use the second conditional in writing.
- I can use 3 connectives of contrast.

Further reading / listening I

- BBC Newsround — short fairness debates for teens.
- Childline UK — *Your rights at school* page.